

Weekend in Columbus — 48-Hour Field Kit

A tight plan for visitors (or locals hosting them). Pick a pace, follow the skeleton, swap freely.

How to use

- 1. Choose **Pace A** (walkable / food-forward) or **Pace B** (mix of city + one outing).
- 2. Check weather Friday night. Use the swap list if storms or extreme heat/cold.
- 3. Park once per neighborhood when you can. Rideshare between clusters at night.

Pace A — Walkable weekend

Saturday

Time	Plan
9:00	Coffee + bakery near your stay
10:00	Short North stroll — galleries / shops on High St
12:30	Lunch in Short North or Italian Village
14:00	Goodale Park loop or North Market browse
16:00	Break at lodging
17:30	German Village — Book Loft + brick-street walk
19:00	Dinner in German Village / Brewery District
21:00	Optional: Arena District for a show or nightcap

Sunday

Time	Plan
9:30	Brunch — Clintonville or German Village
11:30	Scioto Mile walk or Topiary Park
13:30	One museum block (pick one): art / science / history
15:30	Easton or Bridge Park for easy shopping / coffee
17:00	Buffer for travel home

Pace B — City + one outing

Saturday

- Morning: North Market + downtown walk
- Midday: drive or rideshare to **Hocking Hills** or **Ohio Caverns** or a Metro Park hike (pick based on drive time)

- Evening: return for Short North dinner

Sunday

- Slow brunch
- One neighborhood only (German Village or Clintonville)
- Early exit for travelers

Neighborhood pairing guide

Pair	Why it works	Avoid
Short North → German Village	Different energy, easy story for guests	Trying to “do everything” on High St twice
Clintonville → Scioto	Calm morning, open-air afternoon	Rush-hour I-71 frustration without a buffer
Easton → hotel reset	Low-friction for families	Expecting walkable historic charm

Weather-flex swaps

- **Heavy rain:** museums, Book Loft, North Market, mall corridors at Easton
- **Heat advisory:** shade walks early, indoor afternoon, patio dinner only after 7pm
- **Snow / ice:** cut the outing; keep one neighborhood walking radius

Parking & movement notes

- ☐ Decide Friday: car-heavy vs rideshare-heavy weekend
- ☐ Screenshot overnight parking rules for your stay
- ☐ For Saturday night, pre-pin a backup restaurant 5 minutes away
- ☐ Build a 30-minute buffer before any tickets/reservations

Guest packing checklist (1 bag)

- ☐ Comfortable walking shoes
- ☐ Light layer (Ohio swings)
- ☐ Portable charger
- ☐ Reusable water bottle
- ☐ Small umbrella or cap
- ☐ Reservation confirmations offline

One decision to make before Friday

Circle one: **food-first** · **outdoors-first** · **culture-first**

Everything else in this kit supports that choice.

Buckeye Trail Guide · Curated by Keith Householder · Columbus, Ohio

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